

Jakarta

[Jakarta](#) is the capital city of the Republic of Indonesia. Jakarta is a huge, sprawling metropolis, home to over 10 million people with diverse ethnic group backgrounds from all over Indonesia. During the day, the number increases with commuters making their way to work in the city and flock out again in the evenings.

Located on the northwest of Java Island, the province of DKI Jakarta has rapidly expanded through the years, absorbing many villages in the process. In fact, Jakarta is a conglomeration of villages known as *kampung*, now crossed by main roads and superhighways.

The Charm of the Metropolis

A part of the local experience is that you may drive down one wide avenue one minute, then suddenly find yourself squeezed into a small street together with scores of cars and motorbikes. With its many suburbs, Jakarta has become a [Megapolitan city](#). Therefore, when you visit Jakarta it is best to invest in a good map or rely on GPS to navigate around.

Jakarta is not only the seat of the national government and the provincial government, but it is also Indonesia's political center. Moreover, Jakarta is the hub of Indonesia's national finance and trade. It is no wonder, that you will find Jakarta as a dynamic city, with activities taking place around-the-clock throughout its populated areas.

This city is divided into 5 districts, namely *Jakarta Pusat*, *Jakarta Utara*, *Jakarta Barat*, *Jakarta Timur*, and *Jakarta Selatan*. The term ‘Jabodetabek’ refers to *Jakarta-Bogor-Depok-Tangerang-Bekasi* - [the Greater Jakarta area](#) consists of megacities surrounding the capital.

Jakarta Pusat or central Jakarta is where you can find the iconic landmarks such as Monas, [The Merdeka Palace](#), [The National Museum](#), [Istiqlal Mosque](#), The [Jakarta Cathedral](#), and Monumen Selamat Datang or the welcome monument widely renowned as Bunderan HI.

Some of the most prestigious shopping malls and upscale hotels are located right in the heart of Central Jakarta. Here you can enjoy the 24 hours excitements of Jakarta!

Jakarta Utara or North Jakarta is where Taman Impian Jaya Ancol or [Ancol Dreamland](#) is located. It boasts a variety of amusements such as Dufan Theme park, Seaworld, Atlantis Water Adventure Park, Ecopark, an Art market and comfortable accommodation choices with a complete culinary destination.

From Ancol Bay, you can hop on a boat and head to Jakarta’s pristine getaway, enriched with tropical islands named Kepulauan Seribu, or The Seribu Archipelago and sometimes also simply famous as The Thousand Islands.

Here, there are more than 10 islands that one can explore. Some of the most famous are Bidadari, Tidung, Pari and Pulau Macan, the home of private beach huts that lets you plunge directly from your bed to the open sea.

Jakarta Barat or West Jakarta, Jakarta Timur or East Jakarta and Jakarta Selatan or South Jakarta are those areas where a cluster of houses are located alongside offices, public facilities and more choices of shopping malls!

The amazing historical heritage in West Jakarta is Museum Fatahillah and its surrounding Kota Tua or Old Jakarta district is where you can ride a classic bike to tour the area. The new iconic destination in West Jakarta is the contemporary art exhibition venue named Museum Macan, where Yayoi Kusama's artworks are displayed.

In East Jakarta, you can visit Taman Mini Indonesia Indah, the miniature of Indonesia Archipelago. You can explore the details of traditional houses and a glimpse of Indonesia's diverse culture in this park.

When visiting South Jakarta, make sure to drop by at [Setu Babakan](#) and get to know the story of Betawi culture, the native ethnic group of Jakarta. There are a museum and traditional Betawi houses with few activities that you can experience, such as getting to know the traditional dance and music, tasting the local beverage of Bir Pletok, have a bite of Kerak Telor and making small ondel ondel, the iconic figure of Jakarta!

All parts of Jakarta are studded with their own culinary icons and trending coffee shops to spend the day at. Here, you can easily find the five national foods, namely Nasi Goreng, Gado-gado, Soto, Sate, and Rendang.

Indonesia's Independence Day is also celebrated annually on the 17th of August with various activities throughout the nation. Especially in Jakarta, you will find communities decorating their homes with the national color of red and white.

Unique games and races are packed with participants of all ages. Balap Karung or the sack race and Panjat Pinang or the Pinang climb are two iconic games that are always crowded with spectators.

1) Indonesia National Monument (Monas)

The Indonesia National Monument (Monas) towers 433 feet (132 meters) above Jakarta's geographical center, topped with a gilded flame. Designed by Indonesia's first president, Sukarno, it houses a museum of dioramas and an observation platform.

2) Sunda Kelapa (Jakarta Old Port)

Jakarta's old port, Sunda Kelapa is a popular stop on any tour of historic Jakarta (or Batavia, as it once was). Wooden 2-masted pinisi sailing ships still moor here, while porters move goods to and fro as they have since the 13th century. Converted warehouses hold the Maritime Museum, and a watchtower and lighthouses stand guard over the bustling harbor.

3) National Museum

Opened in 1868, in a grand building on Merdeka Square, Indonesia's National Museum is one of Jakarta's most fascinating attractions. A rich collection spanning hundreds of thousands of years covers everything from early hominids to the archipelago's spectacular range of textiles, along with gold, statuary, and architectural models.

4) Glodok (Jakarta Chinatown)

Jakarta Chinatown, better known to locals as Glodok, was born after the massacre of 5,000 Chinese in 1740, when the remaining population were moved to a separate settlement outside the city walls. Today it's a bustling hub where Chinese eateries, temples, street markets, and medicine shops nudge up against electronics stores.

5) Taman Mini Indonesia Indah (Beautiful Indonesia in Miniature Park)

In East Jakarta, Taman Mini Indonesia Indah (Beautiful Indonesia Mini Park) showcases the sheer diversity of this archipelago of approximately 18,000 islands. The 247-acre (100-hectare) space houses full-scale replicas of homes from different cultures, plus museums, theaters, gardens, a waterpark, an aviary, an IMAX cinema, a cable car, and more.

6) Fatahillah Square (Taman Fatahillah)

Fatahillah Square (Taman Fatahillah) is the heart of the Jakarta Old Town (Kota Tua) with a cobbled square with historic colonial buildings. Notable landmarks include the Cafe Batavia restaurant and bar, Wayang Museum of puppetry, and Jakarta History Museum, housed in the old town hall.

7) Museum Wayang (Puppet Museum)

In a historic building on Fatahillah Square, at the heart of Jakarta's Old Town, the Wayang Museum is devoted to Indonesia's rich tradition of puppetry. Puppets are on display from across the archipelago, as well as Asia and Europe, and include shadow puppets, giant costume-style puppets, and rod puppets more similar to those found in the West.

8) Jalan Surabaya Market (Pasar Antik Jalan Surabaya)

Jakarta's best-known street market, Jalan Surabaya Flea Market (Pasar Jalan Surabaya) offers a cornucopia of choice, from factory-made junk and (generally) fake antiques to vintage finds. Head here for everything from textiles to jewelry, furniture, old coins, ship salvage, rare vinyls, old typewriters, and ancient cameras.

9) Pejaten Village

Jakarta's middle classes love a good mall as much as any southeast Asian cosmopolitans, and South Jakarta's Pejaten Village contains many key elements. A medium-size mall, Pejaten

Village has junk food by the gallon, popular Indonesian mall brands such as Matahari department stores, and a smattering of international brand names too.

10) Ancol Dreamland (Taman Impian Ancol)

Jakarta's favorite recreation area, Ancol Dreamland (Taman Impian Ancol) occupies a slice of waterfront. First opened in the 1960s, the site houses beaches, hotels, a gondola, food options, and tourist attractions. Some of the best-known are: Fantasy World (Dunia Fantasi), Ocean Dream Samudra, Sea World Ancol, and Atlantis Water Adventures.

11) Ancol Ocean Dream Samudra

Ancol Ocean Dream Samudra, an "edutainment" theme park, centers on dolphins but is home to creatures including sea lions and penguins. In addition to animal and stunt shows, the park has a 4D cinema and an underwater theater with shows featuring dolphins and divers. Children will enjoy the small selection of rides and the bird park.

12) KidZania Jakarta

Indonesia's first outpost of the children's edutainment concept that's taken the world by storm, KidZania Jakarta occupies over 80,000 square feet (7,500 square meters) of space in South Jakarta. Younger kids will thrill to the opportunity to role-play careers from firefighter and doctor to beauty therapist in a miniature model city.

13) Waterbom Jakarta

Sibling to the hugely popular Waterbom Bali, Waterbom Jakarta is a North Jakarta water park. Occupying around 9 acres (4 hectares) of landscaped grounds in Pantai Indah Kapuk (PIK), it offers slides, artificial waves, a lazy river, and areas for younger kids. There are a range of food options as well as gazebos for rent.

14) Kota Tua (Old Town)

Step back into Dutch colonial times with cobblestone streets, street performers, and heritage buildings centered around Fatahillah Square

15) Plaza Indonesia or Central Park Mall

For high-end boutiques and dining

16) Merdeka Square

This monumental square is one of the main sights of Jakarta and spans over 1km. To put it into perspective, this square is five times the size of the gigantic Tiananmen Square in Beijing! In the centre of this open space is the National Monument, and surrounding this iconic statue is a series of footpaths, wooded areas, and beautiful water features.

When you're in Jakarta, take some time (and some pretty sturdy walking shoes) to visit this square. It's one of the best things to do in Jakarta; that's gorgeous on a sunny day.

17) Thousand Islands

The Thousand Islands are a chain located off the north coast of Jakarta and provide a plethora of opportunities for those wanting to step outside the boundaries of the capital. For us, we knew we had to have a little taste of these islands, and it's relatively easy to organise a trip (or a stay) when visiting Jakarta.

Now, there isn't quite a Thousand Islands to explore, but there are loads, each with its own charm. Once you arrive in Jakarta, speak to the concierge in the hotel who can help organise your tour. We decided on hiring a boat and skipper to take us for the day, but if you want to keep costs lower, you can opt for a shared tour that'll take you to the main islands.

18) National Gallery

Created in 1999, the National Gallery aims to showcase beautiful Indonesian talent and is the perfect place to visit to check out some rather significant artwork from Indonesia.

This fantastic complex contains over 1700 individual pieces from well-known Indonesian artists such as Raden Saleh, Affandi and Basuki Abdullah (if you don't know who those are now, you'll certainly know and will probably be a fan by the time you leave). The art gallery also has some foreign pieces of work here from artists like Hans Hartung and Victor Vasarely. For art lovers, exploring the National Gallery will be a total gem and one of the best things to do in Jakarta! Also, if it's views and cocktails you're after, pop over to the rooftop bar of [Skye](#). Perched over fifty floors up (in the Grand Indonesia Tower), it's one epic place to watch the sunset.

